Reducing Procrastination

Through Incentivized Early Submission

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Who Are We?

Why Procrastination?

In Academia:

Submitting right before the deadline is **fine**

In Industry:

Submitting right before the deadline is ***unacceptable***

50%

Of responders in **2022 AND 2026** indicated challenges with time management and procrastination

79

Viable weaknesses in 2022 and 2026

28%

Of responses mentioned time management or procrastination

13%

More responses mentioned in 2026 compared to 2022

Our Solution: **Incentivized Early Submission**

Bonus Structure

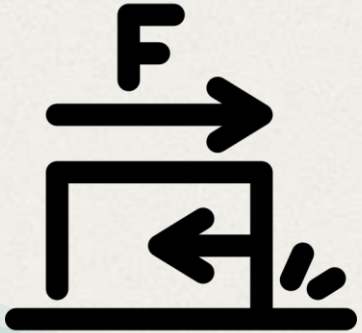
- **48+** hours prior to the deadline → **+5%**
- **24-48** hours prior to the deadline → **+2.5%**

Note: Grades **above 100%** can be rewarded at professors' discretion

Implementation

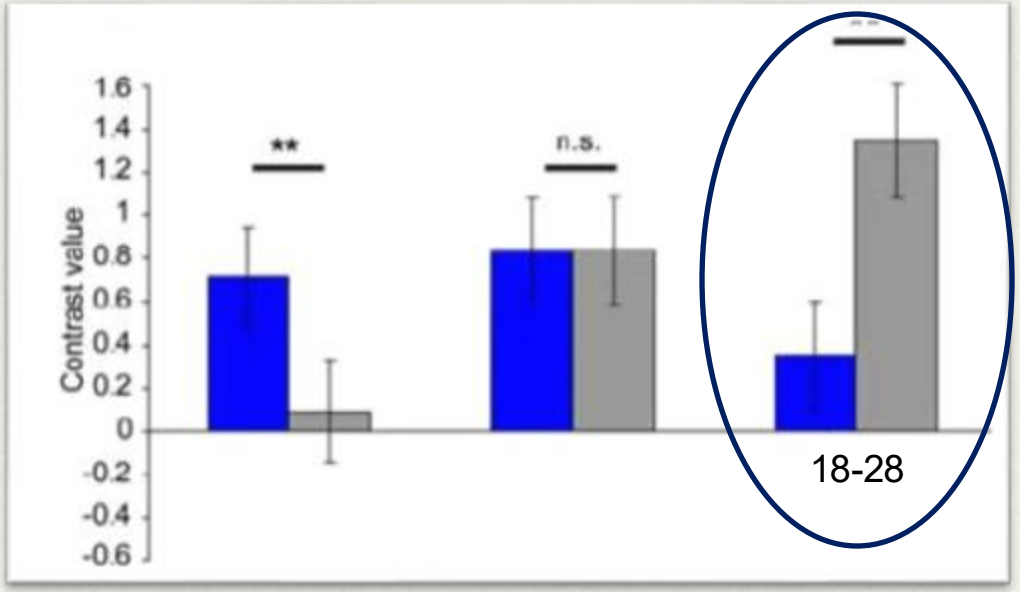
The Mechanism

Low Friction



The Costs

Increased brain activation



https://doi.org/10.1523/JNEUROSCI.1485-08.2008

According to a study at the University of Illinois...

"[positive reinforcement] can... increase students' motivation to complete assignments and maintain good grades"

"strategic reward intervention could effectively decrease students' absenteeism"

(PDF) The Influence of School's Reward Systems on Students' Development

Call To Action

The Failure

The data is screaming at us. Students identify as "**procrastinator[s]**" and "**poor planner[s]**" who suffer because of it.

Simultaneously, they want to be disciplined; listing "**time management**" as a core strength they possess but struggle to deploy.

The Fix

We cannot change human nature, but we can change the incentive.

The data proves our students are struggling to start. Let's stop rewarding the finish line and start rewarding the launch.

Prepare students for the **Real World**:

Real Consequences

Real Rewards